

The Accelerate Adoption of Wood Processing Innovation Program was announced as an election commitment under A Future Grown in Australia: A Better plan for forestry and forest products, released on 2 May 2022.

The Australian Government is supporting 28 grantees across Australia with \$81.30 million in grant funding. The grant funding provides co-investment with privately-owned wood processors to adopt new and upgraded wood processing facilities.

The program aims to enhance the forestry sectors' ability to supply more of Australia's wood demands into the future.

The grants will support the medium to long-term sustainability of wood processors to:

- adopt innovative practices to improve their use of available wood supplies
- increase their production facilities
- add value to existing and new product lines
- reduce the industry's carbon footprint.

The program offers co-funding of up to 40 per cent of total project costs, with the remaining 60 per cent to be met by the applicant.

Grant applications opened from 22 December 2022 until 28 February 2023 with funding available from 2022-23 to 2025-26 and a total of 84 applications were received.

There are 28 projects totalling \$81.30 million funded across Australia ranging between \$1 million to \$5 million.

Funding Recipient	Project	Funding	Region
Highland Pine Products Pty Limited	Greenmill Infeed Upgrade To install a helix screw type log feeder, log scanning systems, extended length infeed, vee-rail canter, vertical feed rolls and optimisation software.	\$4,019,325.00	NSW
	Case study video		
Duncan's Holdings Ltd	Dry Mill Upgrade and Firewood Automation Project To construct and install a linear scanner and docker to replace the manually graded end trim system at Pentarch's Herons Creek site.	\$3,253,890.00	NSW
	Weathertex Capacity Upgrade To install several items of new equipment and modify existing equipment to increase the overall capacity,	\$2,400,000.00	NSW

capability, delivery, and energy efficiency of the Weathertex Raymond Terrace manufacturing facility.

Advanced Manufacturing Plant

Albert Johnson Pty Ltd	To establish new premises, with new machinery and electrical infrastructure that will increase timber processing capacity and allow diversification of production capabilities.	\$1,994,544.00	NSW
Dja Dja Wurrung Clans Aboriginal Corporation (trading as DJAARA)	Galk-galk by DJAARA - a Dja Dja Wurrung sustainable timber business To purchase innovative technology, machinery, and equipment to test and find the highest value use for sustainably harvested DJAARA timber products and heal Country.	\$1,441,915.00	VIC
AKD Queensland Pty Ltd	Project Straighten Up To improve timber recovery in the Caboolture Green Mill, increase capacity of the mill and improve the quality of the product presented to the downstream processes and finished goods.	\$5,000,000.00	QLD
Hyne & Son Pty. Limited	Hyne Timber Efficiency, Diversification and Emission Reduction Project To purchase and install an additional sorting line and new kiln automation capacity at the Tuan Mill, a new automation equipment line at the Glue Laminated Timber plant and a new processing equipment at the Tumbarumba Mill.	\$5,000,000.00	NSW QLD
Pentarch Forestry Services Pty Ltd	A comprehensive fibre utilisation advancement To undertake a comprehensive upgrade, investing in state-of-the-art technologies and equipment in scanning, sorting, debarking, and drying, improving fibre recovery.	\$4,200,000.00	QLD
Parkside Building Supplies Pty. Ltd.	Parkside Glue Laminated Timber Project To install 10 large machines to finger joint and glue short pieces of timber together for potential use in the	\$3,480,000.00	QLD

manufacture of decking products, solid post or beams for construction purposes, or laminated timber bench tops.

Mareeba Sawmills Technological Investment Project

Mareeba Sawmills Pty Ltd	To replace existing sawmill equipment with technologically advanced machinery that will deliver increased sawmill processing capacity, increased sawn timber recovery, timber drying stability and increased processing efficiency.	\$1,793,640.00	QLD
--------------------------	---	----------------	-----

Kennedys Timbers Wood Processing Innovation Project

Kennedy's Classic Aged Timbers Pty Ltd	To adopt world class advanced manufacturing technology and use renewable energy to manufacture Australian made innovative timber products from accredited Indigenous sourced forest timber and recycled hardwood in a zero-waste system.	\$1,010,402.66	QLD
--	--	----------------	-----

Modernisation of Milling Machinery

Dyna Group Australia Pty Ltd	To purchase and install a state-of-the-art computer aided Scragg Mill to expand wood milling and processing capabilities.	\$1,194,186.00	QLD
------------------------------	---	----------------	-----

A new Glulam Plant

Tilling Timber Proprietary Limited	To modernise and extend capability by installing a new cold pressed beam, 2 new Hundegger's saws, 3 in/out automated feeds and a H3+ treatment vessel that exceeds BAL-29 building standards.	\$3,305,742.00	NSW VIC QLD
------------------------------------	---	----------------	-------------------

McDonnell Industries Remanufacturing Facilities Upgrade

McDonnell Industries Pty. Ltd.	To install new innovative timber mill processing equipment to enable the business to better utilise available timber supplies, increase production efficiency, add value to existing products and create new products from an increase and diversification of production capabilities.	\$4,005,687.00	SA
--------------------------------	--	----------------	----

Improving small log recovery and best use of timber

Whiteheads Timber Sales Pty Ltd	To install a new log deck, infeed conveyor, log rotator and process changes to improve the accuracy of log	\$3,947,225.00	SA
---------------------------------	--	----------------	----

rotation and alignment prior to cutting; fit a density grading system to the sorter infeed to minimise downgraded product; and increase efficiency by reducing the log gap between processing.

Advanced manufacturing facility

Bedford Services and Advisory Ltd	To install new automated, innovative machinery, upgrade the site layout and access and upgrade important operational amenities and facilities.	\$3,140,000.00 SA
-----------------------------------	--	-------------------

New Sawmill in South Australia

Ashborn Pty Ltd	To establish a new small diameter pulp log sawmill on-site to better utilise small diameter log.	\$2,709,941.00 SA
-----------------	--	-------------------

Pine Timber Recovery Optimisation Project - Advanced equipment and software upgrade

A.J. Forster Pty Ltd	To enable the purchase and installation of advanced automation and control software and timber handling equipment to grade, trim and sort pine timber for optimal production efficiency and resource recovery.	\$1,421,112.00 SA
----------------------	--	-------------------

Expansion and relocation of KSI SAWMILLS PTY LTD

KSI Sawmills Pty. Ltd.	To establish a new mill at Monarto South, SA, which will improve processing capacity and efficiency, as well as increase product diversity and improve workplace safety through automation.	\$1,440,000.00 SA
------------------------	---	-------------------

Automated Timber Stacking System

SA Pine Pty Ltd	To install a new Automated Packing Line and Stacker System to replace manual sorting and stacking to improve work health and safety; reduce Carbon footprint and production costs and increase production capabilities.	\$1,160,000.00 SA
-----------------	---	-------------------

Laminated veneer lumber production capacity increase

Wesbeam Pty Ltd	To invest in advanced technologies that will enable increased yield from logs delivered to Wesbeam's wood processing plant and increase overall plant output.	\$4,486,478.00 WA
-----------------	---	-------------------

Upgrade of the Edger machine centre.	\$3,509,857.00 WA
--------------------------------------	-------------------

Wespine Industries Pty Ltd	To upgrade of the edger machine centre to enable Wespine to maintain its overall competitiveness. Installation of advanced automated machinery		
Worldwide Truss & Frames Pty Ltd	To install advanced automated machinery to increase the capability and capacity of the business, whilst diversifying product offerings.	\$2,370,157.00	WA
NSFP Southwood Pty Ltd	Southwood Plantation Processing Expansion To upgrade the NSFP Southwood sawmill which will see a range of log processing, sawing and handling equipment installed to significantly increase the capacity of the mill.	\$4,957,570.00	TAS
	Case study video		
CLTP Panel Products Pty Ltd	Scaling Cusp Building Solutions To invest in new technology.	\$2,070,000.00	TAS
Western Junction Sawmill Pty Ltd	Advanced small sawlog processing To purchase and install a new scanning twin band resaw that will enable higher recoveries and better use of the plantation nitens sawlogs.	\$1,984,000.00	TAS
	Case study video		
Stronach Industries Group Pty Ltd	Advanced Wood Fibre Value Adding Optimisation System To install a state-of-the-art automated docking and timber material handling systems, along with the latest cutting-edge timber scanning technology.	\$1,000,000.00	TAS
PROJECT.e Pty Ltd	Construction of an activated carbon manufacturing facility To construct and operate a low temperature activation manufacturing facility on the Tiwi Island to produce high value activated carbon using feedstock from the Tiwi Plantation Corporations' 30,000 hectare Acacia mangium plantation.	\$5,000,000.00	NT

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/forestry/industries/accelerate-adoption-of-wood-processing-innovation-program>